

VAISHNAV KAMESWARAN

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Academic Positions

Postdoctoral Researcher

Nov 2023 - Present

Values-Centered Artificial Intelligence (VCAI), University of Maryland, College Park, Maryland

Affiliated with: NSF Institute for Trustworthy AI in Law & Society (TRAILS), College of Information & Institute for Advanced Computer Studies (UMIACS)

PI's: Hal Daumé III, Katie Shilton, Vanessa Frias-Martinez & John Horty

Affiliate Instructor on Record (IOR)

Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

College of Information, University of Maryland, College Park, Maryland

Education

Ph.D. in Information

2017 - 2023

University of Michigan – School of Information, Ann Arbor, Michigan

Dissertation: *Help Facilitates Accessibility: Understanding the Social & Technology-mediated Experiences of People with Visual Impairments in India*

Committee: Sile O'Modhrain, Tiffany Veinot, Robin Brewer, Joyojeet Pal & Anhong Guo

Master of Science in Human-Computer Interaction

University of Michigan – School of Information, Ann Arbor, Michigan

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science

Visveswaraya Technological University, Bangalore, India

Awards and Funding

AWARDS

Diana Forsythe Award - Finalist , American Medical Informatics Association (AMIA)	2025
UMSI Dissertation Fellowship , University of Michigan – School of Information	2023
Predoctoral Fellowship , Rackham Graduate School – University of Michigan	2021 - 2022
Diversity and Inclusion Award , ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work	2021
Best Paper Award , ACM Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work	2018
Best Paper Honorable Mention Award , ACM Conference on Computer-Human Interaction	2018
Academic Merit Scholarship , University of Michigan – School of Information	2013 - 2015
Best Outgoing Student , Ramaiah Institute of Technology	2010

RESEARCH GRANTS (~\$113,000)

\$9,000 Uncovering AI risks for people with disabilities, Maryland Initiative for Digital Accessibility	2024
\$60,000 Designing AI-powered DIY Communication Tools with AAC users, Google (Co-PI)	2024
\$6,500 Rackham International Research Award, University of Michigan - International Institute	2021
\$20,000 U-M Poverty Solutions Faculty Grant, University of Michigan (Grant Writer)	2020

\$8,500	Shared Mobility Systems for Underserved Groups – REU Supp, <i>NSF (Grant Writer)</i>	2020
\$3,500	U-M Ginsberg Center Faculty Engagement Grant, <i>University of Michigan (Grant Writer)</i>	2020
\$1,500	Rackham Pre-Candidate Research Grant, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2019
\$1,000	Rackham Travel Grant, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2017 - 2020

Publications

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

J7. Alicia K Williamson, Marcy G Antonio, Sage Davis, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Tawanna R Dillahun, Lorraine R Buis, Tiffany C Veinot. 2024. Human technology intermediation to reduce cognitive load: understanding healthcare staff members' practices to facilitate telehealth access in a Federally Qualified Health Center patient population. In *Journal of the American Medical Informatics Association*. Volume 31, Issue 4, April 2024, Pages 832–845.

J6. Marcy Antonio, Alicia Williamson, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Ashley Beals, Elizabeth Ankrah, Shannon Goulet, Ivy Wang, Grecia Macias, Jade James-Gist, Lindsay K Brown, Sage Davis, Srijanani (Jan) Pillai, Lorraine Buis, Tawanna Dillahun, Tiffany C Veinot. 2023. Targeting Patients' Cognitive Load for Telehealth Video Visits Through Student-Delivered Helping Sessions at a United States Federally Qualified Health Center: Equity-Focused, Mixed Methods Pilot Intervention Study. In *Journal of Medical Internet Research*. J Med Internet Res 2023;25:e42586.

J5. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Vidhya Yellareddy, and Megh Marathe. 2023. Advocacy as Access Work: How People with Visual Impairments Gain Access to Digital Banking in India. In *Proceedings of ACM Human-Computer Interaction*. Interact. 7, CSCW1, Article 120 (April 2023), 23 pages.

J4. Maulishree Pandey, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Hrishikesh V. Rao, Sile O'Modhrain, and Steve Oney. 2021. Understanding Accessibility and Collaboration in Programming for People with Visual Impairments. In *Proceedings of ACM Human-Computer Interaction*. Interact. 5, CSCW1, Article 129 (April 2021), 30 pages. **Diversity and Inclusion Award**

J3. **Vaishnav Kameswaran** and Srihari Hulikal Muralidhar. 2019. Cash, Digital Payments and Accessibility: A Case Study from Metropolitan India. In *Proceedings of ACM Human-Computer Interaction*. Vol. 3, CSCW, Article 97 (November 2019), 23 pages.

J2. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Jatin Gupta, Joyojeet Pal, Sile O'Modhrain, Tiffany C. Veinot, Robin Brewer, Aakanksha Parameshwar, Vidhya Y, and Jacki O'Neill. 2018. 'We can go anywhere': Understanding Independence through a Case Study of Ride-hailing Use by People with Visual Impairments in metropolitan India. In *Proceedings of ACM Human-Computer Interaction*. Vol. 2, CSCW, Article 85 (November 2018), 24 pages. **Best Paper Award**

J1. Joyojeet Pal, Priyank Chandra, Padma Chirumamilla, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Andre Gonawela, Udit Thawani, Pritika Dasgupta. 2017. Mediatized Populism: Innuendo as Outreach: @narendramodi and the Use of Political Irony on Twitter. In *International Journal of Communication*. October 2017, 22 pages.

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

C15. Lining Wang, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Hernisa Kacorri. 2025. Toward A Taxonomy of Algorithmic Harms for Disability: A Systematic Review. In *Proceedings of the 8th AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics and Society (AIES '25)*. Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence/Association for Computing Machinery, Madrid, Spain.

C14. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Jerry Robinson, Nithya Sambasivan, Gaurav Aggarwal, Meredith Ringel Morris. 2024. Help and the Social Construction of Access. In *Proceedings of the 26th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '24)*. Association for Computing Machinery, St.John's, NL, Canada.

C13. Divya Ramesh, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Ding Wang, Nithya Sambasivan. 2022. How platform-user power relations shape algorithmic accountability: A case study of instant loan platforms and financially stressed users in India. In *Proceedings of the 2022 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '22)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA.

C12. Tawanna R Dillahunt, Erica Poon, Samantha E Rasmussen, Juan F Maestre, John Osorio Torres, Patrick C Shih, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Mia Gallardo, Alice Bagley, Samuel LA Young. 2022. Trust, Reciprocity, and the Role of Timebanks as Intermediaries: Design Implications for Addressing Healthcare Transportation Barriers. In *Proceedings of the 2022 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '22)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA.

C11. Juan F. Maestre, Tawanna Dillahunt, Alec Andrew Theisz, Megan Furness, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Tiffany Veinot, and Patrick C. Shih. 2021. Examining Mobility Among People Living with HIV in Rural Areas. In *Proceedings of the 2021 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '21)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 201, 1–17.

C10. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Alexander Fiannaca, Melanie Kniesel, Amy Karlson, Ed Cutrell, Meredith Ringel Morris. 2020. Understanding In-Situ Use of Commonly Available Navigation Technologies by People with Visual Impairments. In *Proceedings of the 22nd International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '20)*. Association for Computing Machinery, NY, USA.

C9. Robin N. Brewer and **Vaishnav Kameswaran**. 2019. Understanding Trust, Transportation, and Accessibility through Ridesharing. In *Proceedings of the 2019 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '19)*. Association for Computing Machinery, NY, USA, Paper 195, 1–11.

C8. Robin N. Brewer and **Vaishnav Kameswaran**. 2018. Understanding the Power of Control in Autonomous Vehicles for People with Vision Impairment. In *Proceedings of the 20th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '18)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 185–197.

C7. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Lindsey Cameron, and Tawanna R. Dillahunt. 2018. Support for Social and Cultural Capital Development in Real-time Ridesharing Services. In *Proceedings of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '18)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Paper 342, 1–12.

C6. Tawanna R. Dillahun, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Desiree McLain, Minnie Lester, Delores Orr, and Kentaro Toyama. 2018. Entrepreneurship and the Socio-Technical Chasm in a Lean Economy. In *Proceedings of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '18)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Paper 240, 1–14. **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award**

C5. Joyojeet Pal, Priyank Chandra, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Aakanksha Parameshwar, Sneha Joshi, and Aditya Johri. 2018. Digital Payment and Its Discontents: Street Shops and the Indian Government's Push for Cashless Transactions. In *Proceedings of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '18)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Paper 229, 1–13.

C4. Joyojeet Pal, Anjuli Dasika, Ahmad Hasan, Jackie Wolf, Nick Reid, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Purva Yardi, Allyson Mackay, Abram Wagner, Bhramar Mukherjee, Sucheta Joshi, Sujay Santra, and Priyamvada Pandey. 2017. Changing data practices for community health workers: Introducing digital data collection in West Bengal, India. In *Proceedings of the Ninth International Conference on Information and Communication Technologies and Development (ICTD '17)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 17, 1–12.

C3. Joyojeet Pal, Anandhi Viswanathan, Priyank Chandra, Anisha Nazareth, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Hariharan Subramonyam, Aditya Johri, Mark S. Ackerman, and Sile O'Modhrain. 2017. Agency in Assistive Technology Adoption: Visual Impairment and Smartphone Use in Bangalore. In *Proceedings of the 2017 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '17)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 5929–5940.

C2. Tawanna R. Dillahun, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Linfeng Li, and Tanya Rosenblat. 2017. Uncovering the Values and Constraints of Real-time Ridesharing for Low-resource Populations. In *Proceedings of the 2017 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '17)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 2757–2769.

C1. Jasmine Hentschel, Samyukta Manjappa Sherugar, Rui Zhou, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Rajesh Chandwani, and Neha Kumar. 2017. Rice Today, Roti Tomorrow: Diets and Diabetes in Urban Indian Households. In *Proceedings of the 2017 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '17)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 4069–4081.

NON-REFEREED ARTICLES, BOOK CHAPTERS, etc.

B3. Cella M Sum, Franchesca Spektor, Rahaf Alharbi, Leya Breanna Baltaxe-Admony, Erika Devine, Hazel Anneke Dixon, Jared Duval, Tessa Eagle, Frank Elavsky, Kim Fernandes, Leandro S Guedes, Serena Hillman, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Lynn Kirabo, Tamanna Motahar, Kathryn E Ringland, Anastasia Schaadhardt, Laura Scheepmaker, Alicia Williamson. 2024. Challenging Ableism: A Critical Turn Toward Disability Justice in HCI. In *XRDS: Crossroads, The ACM Magazine for Students*.

B2. Maulishree Pandey, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Hrishikesh V. Rao, Sharvari Bondre, Sile O'Modhrain, and Steve Oney. 2023. UI Development Experiences of Programmers with Visual Impairments in Product Teams. In *Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion in Software Engineering*. Apress 2024.

B1. **Kameswaran V.** and Pal J. 2020. Ride-hailing as Accessible Transit. In *Disability and the Developing World*. Oxford University Press 2021.

PEER-REVIEWED SHORT PAPERS

S3. Tamanna Motahar, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, et al. 2025. Accessibility Research Across Borders: Collaboration and Community Building in Accessibility and ICTD Research. In *Proceedings of the 27th International ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '25)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA.

S2. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Shannon Fearday, Abir Viqar, Michelle Meade, Allyson Mackay, Pari Rajavelu, Vetri Natan, and Joyojeet Pal. 2016. Institutional Structures and Culture in Healthcare: A Comparative Case on Health Learning. In *Proceedings of the Eighth International Conference on Information and Communication Technologies and Development (ICTD '16)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 45, 1–4.

S1. Megh Marathe, Priyank Chandra, **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Tsuyoshi Kano, and Syed Ishtiaque Ahmed. 2016. In search of missing pieces: A re-examination of trends in ICTD research. In *Proceedings of the Eighth International Conference on Information and Communication Technologies and Development (ICTD '16)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, Article 60, 1–4.

LIGHTLY PEER-REVIEWED WORKSHOP PAPERS

W6. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Jerry Young, Nithya Sambasivan, Gaurav Aggarwal, Meredith Ringel Morris. AI for Accessibility: An Agenda for the Global South. 2023. In *ASSETS 2023 Workshop on A11y Futures*, New York City, NY.

W5. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Maulishree Pandey, Joshua Guberman, Hrishikesh Rao, Sile O'Modhrain. Experiences of mobility in the Global South: Lessons from People with Visual Impairments in India. 2019. In *CHI 2019 Workshop on Hacking Blind Navigation*, Glasgow, Scotland.

W4. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Megh Marathe, Priyank Chandra. 2018. Redefining the Landmark – Designing Navigation Tools for the Visually Impaired. In *CHI 2018 Workshop on HCI across Borders*, Montreal, Canada.

W3. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Megh Marathe, Priyank Chandra, Priyamvada Pandey, Joyojeet Pal. 2017. Usability in the field: Reflections from an HCI4D project in rural West Bengal. In *CHI 2017 Workshop on HCI across Borders*, Denver, CO.

W2. **Vaishnav Kameswaran** and Rohan Malpani. 2016. Empower me – An Alternate Take on Pervasiveness. In *CHI 2016 Workshop on Pervasive Play*, San Jose, CA.

W1. **Vaishnav Kameswaran**, Megh Marathe, Joyojeet Pal, Tawanna Dillahunt, Katherina Reinecke, Kentaro Toyama. 2016. Project Boost: Addressing the Socio in a Socio-Technical System to Improve Income-Earning opportunities in Detroit. In *CHI 2016 Workshop on HCI across Borders*, San Jose, CA.

Invited Talks

Towards Equitable Technology Futures for People with Disabilities <i>Seminar Series, Mohamed bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence (MBZUAI), UAE</i>	Apr 2025
Towards Equitable Technology Futures for People with Disabilities <i>Seminar Series, University of Maine</i>	Apr 2025
On AI, Employment & People with Disabilities <i>Department of Rehabilitation Services, State of Maryland</i>	Mar 2025
Bridging the AI Divide: Towards Equitable Technology Futures for People with Disabilities <i>Seminar Series, Florida International University</i>	Nov 2024
Inclusive Design & Innovation <i>Technology & the Developing World, Michigan State University</i>	Sep 2024
AI & People with Disabilities <i>THAT Lab Seminar, University of Maryland – College Park</i>	Aug 2024
Community-Centered Approaches to AI Design <i>VCAI & TRAILS Spring Tutorials, University of Maryland – College Park</i>	Apr 2024
UX, Accessibility and the Majority World <i>INF2201H: ICTs, Design, and Marginality, University of Toronto</i>	Mar 2024
On the Potential of AI for People with Disabilities <i>VCAI Research Seminar, University of Maryland – College Park</i>	Mar 2024
AI & People with Disabilities <i>Research Seminar, University of Maryland – Baltimore County</i>	Mar 2024
Bridging the AI Divide: Towards Equitable Technology Futures for People with Disabilities <i>INFO Science Seminar Series, University of Colorado - Boulder</i>	Mar 2024
Participatory AI <i>CMSC 116: Generative AI, You and I, University of Maryland – College Park</i>	Feb 2024
Programming & Human-Computer Interaction <i>Research Seminar, Carleton College</i>	Mar 2023
HCI and Accessibility <i>SI 710 - Methods for Underserved Populations, University of Michigan</i>	Feb 2020
“We can go anywhere”: Ride-hailing for People with Visual Impairments in India <i>Global South Asia Conference, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, Michigan</i>	Jun 2019

Uber Accessibility: Examining Ride-hailing Use by People with Visual Impairments in India Jul 2018
Uber Technologies Inc

Research Experience

Research Intern Jun 2021 – Aug 2021
Google Research & Google Lookout, Mountain View, CA
Hosts: Gaurav Aggarwal & Nithya Sambasivan

Research Intern Jun 2019 – Sep 2019
Enable Group, Microsoft Research, Redmond, Seattle
Hosts: Alex Fiannaca, Melanie Kniesel, Meredith Ringel Morris & Ed Cutrell

Visiting Researcher Jun 2017 – Aug 2017
Technology for Emerging Markets Group, Microsoft Research India, Bangalore, India
Host: Jacki O'Neill

Visiting Researcher Jun 2016 – Aug 2016
Technology for Emerging Markets Group, Microsoft Research India, Bangalore, India
Host: Bill Theis

Research Assistant May 2015 – June 2017
University of Michigan – School of Information, Ann Arbor, MI
Advisors: Joyojeet Pal, Tawanna Dillahunt, Kentaro Toyoma

Professional Experience

User Experience Design Intern Sep 2014 – Dec 2014
Court Innovations, Ann Arbor, Michigan

User Experience Research Intern May 2014 – Aug 2014
Quicken Loans, Detroit, Michigan

Software Developer Sep 2010 – Aug 2013
Aditi Technologies, Bengaluru, India

Teaching

Affiliate Instructor on Record (IOR), INST704 – Inclusive Design in HCI Fall 2024
University of Maryland

Graduate Student Instructor, SI 582 - Fundamentals of Interaction Design Fall 2022
University of Michigan

Graduate Student Instructor, SI 422 - Needs Assessment and Usability Fall 2019
University of Michigan

Graduate Student Instructor, **SI 682 - Advanced User Research Methods**
University of Michigan

Winter 2019

Graduate Student Instructor, **SI 582 - Fundamentals of Interaction Design**
University of Michigan

Fall 2018

Service

Program Committee, ASSETS	2025
Associate Chair, FAccT	2025
Program Committee, ASSETS	2024
Program Committee, ICTD	2024
Associate Chair, FAccT	2024
Associate Chair, CHI	2023 - 2025
Reviewer, CHI	2018 - 2025
Reviewer, CSCW	2018 - 2023
Area Chair, CHI Late Breaking Work	2018 - 2020
Student Representative, UMSI Doctoral Executive Committee	2019 - 2020

Mentoring

Aakanksha Parameshwar, Master's Student University of Michigan (<i>First Position: UX Researcher, Google</i>)	2017 - 2018
Josue Figueroa, Master's Student University of Michigan (<i>First Position: UX Researcher, Blink</i>)	2020 - 2022
Erica Poon, Undergraduate Student University of Michigan (<i>Current: Master's Student, University of Michigan</i>)	2020 - 2022
Kartik Joshi, Undergraduate Student Vellore Institute of Technology (<i>Current: Master's Student, IIIT - Bangalore</i>)	2020 - Present
Valentia Hong, Undergraduate Student University of Maryland, College Park	2024 - Present
Jazmin Maria Clark, Undergraduate Student Georgetown University	2024 - Present
Aryan Thakker, Undergraduate Student University of Maryland, College Park	2024 - Present
Macfayden Nichols, Undergraduate Student Brown University	2024 - Present

David Onafuwa, Undergraduate Student
University of Maryland, College Park

2024 - Present

News & Other Coverage

Accessible AI Requires Involving and Collaborating with People with Disabilities Everywhere Learner	2025
Bridging code and conscience: UMD's quest for ethical and inclusive AI AI News	2024
Risky teleoperation, Rocket League simulation and zoologist multiplication TechCrunch Perceptron	2022
‘We can go anywhere’ Transportation Research Board	2022
Accessibility for Passengers with Sensory and Cognitive Disabilities U.S. Access Board	2021
Modi's sarcasm and humour behind his Twitter popularity Business Standard India	2019
Narendra Modi used political humour, sarcasm to refashion his political style Times of India, Economic Times India, Live Mint India	2017
University of Michigan students unveil projects aimed at helping city of Jackson Ricky Olmos, MLive	2014